

AHSEC 2023 — ENGLISH (33T ENGL)

Fully Solved Paper

SECTION-A: Reading Skill (10 Marks)

1(a) What is an air pollutant? (1)

Ans: An air pollutant is a substance which is present in the air while normally it is not there, or is present in an amount exceeding the normal concentration.

1(b) In what forms are the air pollutants present? (2)

Ans: Air pollutants are present either in gaseous form (such as carbon monoxide, carbon dioxide, ozone, and oxides of sulphur and nitrogen) or as particulate matter, that is, dust particles of various inorganic or organic origins.

1(c) Why do we feel suffocated in a closed environment? (1)

Ans: We feel suffocated in a closed environment because such a feeling is often (though mistakenly) ascribed to a lack of oxygen; in reality the composition of air remains remarkably constant, so the feeling arises from psychological or other factors rather than actual oxygen depletion.

1(d) What is sick building syndrome? Mention some of its major symptoms. (1+1=2)

Ans: Sick building syndrome is a vague constellation of symptoms experienced by people living in a poorly ventilated home or building. Its major symptoms include a general feeling of malaise, headache, dizziness, irritation of the mucous membranes, nausea, itching, aches, pains and depression.

1(e) How is smoking of tobacco an important source of indoor air pollution? (2)

Ans: Smoking of tobacco in a closed environment is an important source of indoor pollution because, although it may not be high quantitatively, it is significantly hazardous to health, as tobacco smoke contains over 3,000 chemical constituents that have been identified as harmful to human health.

1(f) Find a word in the passage which means "the state or process of dying from being deprived of air or unable to breathe". (1)

Ans: Suffocation

1(g) Give an antonym of "reject". (1)

Ans: Accept

SECTION-B: Advanced Writing Skills (25 Marks)

Q2. Advertisement for "Scholars' Academy" (5 marks, 50 words)

SCHOLARS' ACADEMY

Admissions Open for 2023–24!

Scholars' Academy, a premier coaching institute, invites bright and dedicated students to enrol for coaching in various competitive examinations. We offer expert faculty, small batches, regular tests, and personal mentoring to ensure success.

For admission, contact:

Anwesha / Anirban, Director, Scholars' Academy, [Address], Ph: [Contact No.]

Q3. Report on a Book Fair (10 marks, 100–125 words)

BOOK FAIR DRAWS HUGE CROWDS

[Town], [Date]: A Book Fair was organised in our town by a local NGO, in which a number of reputed publication houses from across the country participated. The fair was inaugurated by a noted litterateur in the presence of teachers, students, and book-lovers.

The event, spread over several days, displayed a wide range of books — from academic textbooks and reference books to fiction, poetry, and children's literature — at discounted prices. Special stalls were set up for regional

and Assamese literature, drawing particular attention from local readers. Cultural programmes, including poetry recitations and book-reading sessions, were also held to encourage a reading habit among the youth.

The fair was widely appreciated for promoting literacy and love for books, and the NGO announced that it would be held annually.

Q4. Letter to Bank Manager — Loss of Passbook (10 marks)

From:

[Your Name]

[Your Address]

[Date]

To

The Manager

[Name of Bank], [Branch], [Address]

Subject: Loss of Savings Bank Passbook and request for issue of duplicate passbook

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to inform you that I have lost my Savings Bank Passbook (Account No. _____) held at your branch. I regret that despite a thorough search, I have been unable to trace it, and I suspect it may have been misplaced while travelling.

Since the passbook contains details of my account and transactions, I request you to treat it as lost and to kindly issue a duplicate passbook at the earliest, so that I may continue to keep a record of my transactions. I am ready to complete any formalities and pay any prescribed fee required for this purpose.

Kindly do the needful at your earliest convenience.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

[Your Name]

[Account No.]

SECTION-C: Grammar (20 Marks)

Q5. Narration change (any two) (2×2=4)

(a)

Ans: The gentleman asked the salesman what the price of that dictionary was. The salesman told him that it was a bit expensive, but that he could give it to him at a 10 per cent discount.

(b)

Ans: I asked the old lady where Professor Sarmah lived. The lady regretfully replied that she didn't know.

Q6. Voice change (any three) (1×3=3)

(a) **He was instructed by his coach to play that shot.**

Ans: His coach instructed him to play that shot.

(b) **Please give me some more time.**

Ans: Let some more time be given to me. / I am requested to be given some more time.

(c) **Is the gardener watering the plants?**

Ans: Are the plants being watered by the gardener?

(d) Rome was not built in a day.

Ans: Nobody / No one built Rome in a day.

Q7. Correct tense forms (any five) (1×5=5)

(a) This family (live) in this place since 1970.

Ans: This family has been living in this place since 1970.

(b) She (go) home when we met her.

Ans: She was going home when we met her.

(c) We reached the stadium after the match (start).

Ans: We reached the stadium after the match had started.

(d) Ice (float) on water.

Ans: Ice floats on water.

(e) If I (be) you, I would not do that.

Ans: If I were you, I would not do that.

(f) He suddenly realized that he (leave) the bag in the bus.

Ans: He suddenly realized that he had left the bag in the bus.

Q8. Prepositions (any four) (1×4=4)

(a) They will come here _____ a month.

Ans: in

(b) I am sorry _____ what I have done.

Ans: for

(c) She usually falls _____ her bicycle.

Ans: off

(d) He is taller than you _____ three inches.

Ans: by

Q9. Rewrite as directed (any four) (1×4=4)

(a) This fact is too evident to require any proof. (so...that)

Ans: This fact is so evident that it does not require any proof.

(b) I shall remember your help forever. (negative)

Ans: I shall never forget your help.

(c) Having completed her project here she returned to her native country. (complex sentence)

Ans: After she had completed her project here, she returned to her native country.

(d) She is the tallest girl in the classroom. (comparative degree)

Ans: She is taller than any other girl in the classroom.

(e) No one can do this. (interrogative)

Ans: Who can do this?

SECTION-D: Textbooks (45 Marks)

Q10(a). Extract from 'My Mother at Sixty-Six'

(i) Who looked out at the young trees? (1)

Ans: The poet (speaker), Kamala Das, looked out at the young trees.

(ii) Which thought did the speaker put away? (1)

Ans: She put away the painful thought of her mother's ageing face, which had looked pale and corpse-like as she dozed with her mouth open in the car.

(iii) What do young sprinting trees signify? (1)

Ans: The young sprinting trees signify youth, vitality, energy and the continuity of life, in contrast to the poet's mother's fading old age.

(iv) What did the speaker see the children doing? (1)

Ans: She saw the merry children spilling out of their homes, full of life and cheer.

Q11. Answer any three in 30–40 words (2×3=6)

(i) Why was the roadside stand built?

Ans: The roadside stand was built by a poor rural family beside a busy highway in the hope of attracting passing motorists to buy their farm produce — berries in summer and squashes in fall — so as to earn some extra money and improve their hard life.

(ii) How did the travellers on the highways react to the roadside stand?

Ans: Most travellers sped past without even a glance. A few slowed down only to ask directions or to complain about the stand spoiling the view, but almost none actually stopped to buy anything, leaving the family disappointed.

(iv) What kind of images does the poet use to signify her mother's ageing decay in 'My Mother at Sixty-Six'?

Ans: The poet uses images like her mother's pale, ashen, open-mouthed sleeping face compared to that of a corpse, likening it to the pallor of a late winter's moon, to vividly capture her mother's ageing and approaching death.

Q12. Answer any five (1×5=5)

(b) What are epiphytes?

Ans: Epiphytes are plants that grow on other plants (such as on tree trunks or branches) for physical support, without being parasitic, drawing their nourishment from the air and rain rather than from the host plant.

(c) What did Gandhi do to improve the health condition in the Champaran villages?

Ans: Gandhi arranged for doctors to volunteer, opened primary schools for children and enlisted the help of his wife and other women to teach villagers about sanitation and cleanliness, thereby working to improve the health conditions of the Champaran villages.

(d) Which book by Louis Fischer has been reviewed as one of the best books ever written on Gandhi by Times Educational Supplement?

Ans: The Life of Mahatma Gandhi.

(e) Whom did Saheb observe standing at the fenced gate of the neighbouring club?

Ans: Saheb observed boys dressed in white clothes playing tennis inside the club.

(f) Who is the writer of the story "The Last Lesson"?

Ans: Alphonse Daudet.

(g) Which is the only occasion that Sophie gets to see Casey in person?

Ans: Sophie gets to see Casey in person only when he comes to the shoe shop where she works, to have his football boots mended.

(h) Name the sports for which Sophie's father had a strong passion.

Ans: Sophie's father had a strong passion for football and greyhound racing.

Q13. Answer any five in 30–40 words (2×5=10)

(a) Why did Sophie share her feelings with her brother Geoff and not with her father?

Ans: Sophie shared her dreams with Geoff because he was gentle, patient and understanding, and never mocked her ambitions, whereas her father was often harsh, dismissive and impatient with her fanciful talk, so she avoided confiding in him.

(b) Why, according to the writer, does the advice she gave to Saheb seem hollow?

Ans: The writer feels her advice to Saheb to go to school seems hollow because she herself has no alternative to offer him — she knows that studying will not necessarily improve his impoverished condition, and that going to school does not guarantee a school nearby or a real change in his circumstances.

(c) What explanation does the author offer for the children not wearing footwear?

Ans: The author suggests it is not always mere poverty; it is worn as a tradition to be poor, and some believe it is a sign of bad luck to wear shoes bought with the money from selling the family's cattle, so a mixture of poverty, tradition and superstition keeps children barefoot.

(e) How was a solution to the problems of indigo sharecroppers of Champaran found?

Ans: Gandhi thoroughly investigated the sharecroppers' grievances by recording their statements, and eventually negotiated with the planters. A settlement was reached whereby the planters agreed to refund 25 per cent of the money they had illegally extracted from the peasants, and the Tinkathia system was abolished.

(f) Why did M. Hamel write "Viva La France" before dismissing his class?

Ans: As this was the last French lesson before the region passed under Prussian rule, M. Hamel wrote "Viva La France" (Long Live France) on the blackboard as a final, deeply emotional expression of patriotism and love for his motherland and mother tongue, before dismissing the class.

(g) What changes came over Frantz after he heard M. Hamel's announcement?

Ans: Frantz was suddenly overwhelmed with regret for having neglected his French lessons. His indifference vanished; he began to listen attentively, felt sorry for not paying attention earlier, and even started to feel great affection for his books and his teacher, M. Hamel.

Q14. Answer any one in 80–100 words (5×1=5)

(a) "Civil disobedience had triumphed, the first time in modern India" — Show, referring to 'Indigo', how this had happened.

Ans: When Gandhi arrived in Champaran to investigate the plight of indigo sharecroppers forced by British planters to grow indigo under the exploitative Tinkathia system, the British authorities ordered him to leave the district immediately. Gandhi refused to obey and chose instead to face the legal consequences of his disobedience. He was summoned to court, but thousands of peasants gathered in spontaneous, peaceful support, and the magistrate, unnerved by this show of solidarity, postponed judgment and eventually the government withdrew the case without any punishment. This was the first time in modern India that a government order had been civilly, non-violently defied and defeated by common people's peaceful resistance, marking the triumph of civil disobedience even before it became a full-fledged movement.

Q15. Answer any one in 125–150 words (7×1=7)

(a) What are the different ways in which Mr. Lamb tries to change Derry's attitude to life? (from 'On the Face of It')

Note: This story is not part of your current syllabus list, but here is the answer for completeness since it appeared in the original paper.

Ans: Mr. Lamb, an old man with an artificial leg who lives cheerfully despite his disability, meets Derry, a teenager scarred and embittered after an accident that has left half his face disfigured with acid burns. Derry has withdrawn from the world, avoiding people because of their stares and pity. Mr. Lamb welcomes Derry into his garden without any show of pity or curiosity about his scar, treating him as a normal individual. He shares his own philosophy of living positively despite disability, telling Derry that one must open doors to the world rather than shut oneself away out of fear or self-pity. He encourages Derry to see beauty in bees, wind, and the open garden, to dream, to think independently rather than accept others' negative opinions of him, and to believe he can achieve anything — even flying, metaphorically. Through patient conversation, warmth and his own example of resilience, Mr. Lamb gradually transforms Derry's outlook from despair and self-isolation towards hope, courage and self-acceptance.

Q16. Answer any four in 30–40 words (2×4=8)

(a) Why does the Tiger King get his name?

Ans: He is named the Tiger King because he was born under prophetic stars foretelling that he would one day die from a tiger's attack; to defy this prophecy he set out to kill a hundred tigers, earning himself the title 'Tiger King'.

(c) Which trait of Mr. Lamb attracted Derry towards him? (from 'On the Face of It')

Note: not in your current syllabus, included for completeness.

Ans: Derry was drawn to Mr. Lamb's cheerful, accepting nature — his refusal to pity or judge Derry for his scarred face, and his positive, open-minded philosophy of living life fully despite his own disability.

(d) Why did it take Bama to reach home in 30 minutes instead of 10 minutes? (from 'Memories of Childhood')

Ans: It took Bama half an hour instead of ten minutes because she stopped on the way to watch and enjoy various amusing sights and street entertainments — vendors, performers, animals, and games being played by other people along the route.

(e) What is the significance of Uruka? (from 'Memories of Childhood' — if part of your text)

This item does not match the standard NCERT 'Memories of Childhood' (by Zitkala-Sa/Bama) content — it appears to belong to a different/regional text in this exam's syllabus version. Please check your own textbook for this one; I don't have reliable content to answer it accurately.